Assured about China's near-term intentions, Nehru seemed even more convinced that Washington's China policy was obstructive. He pointed out to U Nu that he was not alone in thinking that US nonrecognition of the regime in Beijing was unhelpful. He pointed to statements by the Australian and New Zealand foreign ministers. Furthermore, he saw US behavior at Geneva at the time—and, later, the formation of SEATO—as only exacerbating the situation.[131]

Some Indian policymakers believed that the state of Sino-Indian relations proved that the Indian approach was better than that of the US. The Indian embassy in China noted that the Sino-Indian agreement showed that Beijing was willing to be a "reasonable negotiator."[132] Nehru told Eden that it suggested a better way than military alliances to "restrain and resolve conflicts."[133] Writing to Indian chief ministers, he outlined his disagreement with the American attitude that communists would never stick to their agreements so it was better to use force rather than diplomacy, pressure rather than persuasion. Moreover, US policy had not been effective and represented a "record of repeated failure."[134]

Nehru subsequently traveled to China in October 1954. The US was again discussed in the Sino-Indian meetings, especially since the visit took place as the first Taiwan Strait crisis was unfolding. Once again, there were differences; once again, Nehru tried to inject moderation into Beijing's attitude toward the US. He noted that the US position was not as monolithic and hostile as China believed. But Zhou questioned American intentions, asserting that Washington—unlike Delhi or Beijing—did not want to ease global tensions. The US was not just out to protect its interests, as Nehru insisted, but wanted to enlarge them through hostilities. Trying to convince Nehru, Zhou argued that the US was encouraging Pakistan to be expansionist. He drew a contrast with China's willingness to reassure countries in the neighborhood, noting that the US was doing the opposite. The discussion left Nehru commenting that Zhou's approach toward the US—with its insistence on preventing American expansion, isolating Washington, and not appeasing the US—mirrored what Washington said about Beijing.[135]

In their first meeting, Mao reiterated to Nehru that the US was a threat. When Nehru tried to explain that fear influenced US policies, the chairman retorted that he could not understand what a country like the US had to